



HOW TO MAKE GINGERBREAD MEN

Ingredients

- * 4 tbsp golden syrup
- * 300g (10½oz) plain flour, plus extra for dusting
- * 1 tsp bicarbonate of soda
- * 1½ tsp ground ginger
- * 1½ tsp mixed spice
- * 100g (3½oz) unsalted butter, softened and diced
- * 155g (5½oz) soft dark brown sugar
- * 1 egg
- * Raisins, to decorate
- * Icing sugar, sifted (optional)

Equipment

- * Pan
- * Mixing bowls
- * Wooden spoon
- * Non-stick baking sheets
- * 11cm (4½in) gingerbread man cutter
- * Wire rack
- * Piping bag with thin nozzle (optional)



1 Preheat the oven to 190°C (375°F/Gas mark 5). Heat the golden syrup until it liquefies, then cool.



2 Sift the flour, bicarbonate of soda, and spices into a bowl. Add the butter. Rub together with your fingertips until the mixture looks like fine breadcrumbs.



3 Add the sugar to the breadcrumbs mixture and mix well.



4 Beat the egg into the cooled syrup until well blended.



5 Pour the syrup into the flour mix. Bring together to a rough dough.

